ADDING PAGE NUMBERING IN PDF DOCUMENTS

Last updated: August 18, 2025

NOTE: *There are several methods of adding page numbering in PDF documents and this is just one of them. The instructions are intended only as a general description of the process. These instructions were prepared using Adobe Acrobat Pro DC. Your procedure may vary depending on which PDF creation software you are using.*

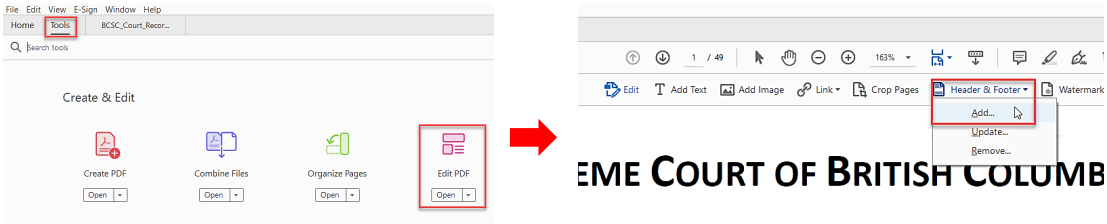
Sequential page numbering needs to be added when combining multiple documents together in one combined PDF document. This can be done through the **Header & Footer** function in Adobe Pro.

Using Adobe Acrobat Pro DC, you can automatically add page numbers in a combined PDF document.

Using the Header & Footer Function

1. Open the combined PDF document in Adobe Acrobat Pro DC.

2. Under the **Tools** toolbar (or in the Edit menu bar) choose **Edit PDF.** Then click on **Header & Footer** toolbar, and choose **Add …**



Note: *A pop-up indicating that your file already contains a header or footer may pop up. Choose* **Add New***.*

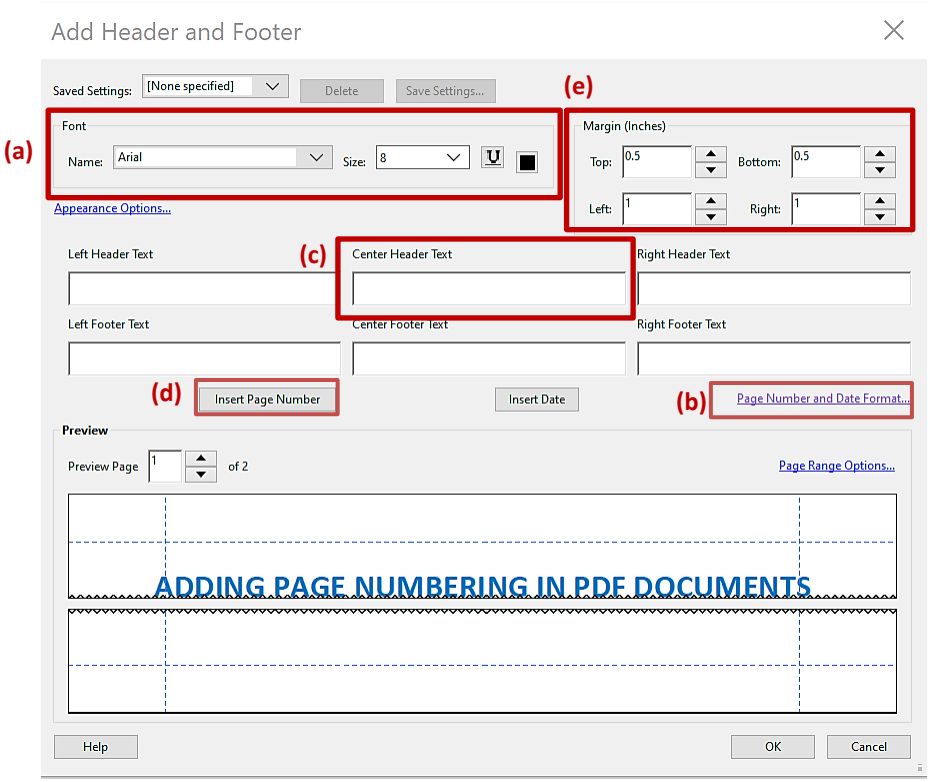
In the **Add Header and Footer** dialog box:

a) Choose your font and font size. Set the font to Arial Bold, and the font size to at least 14 to ensure the page numbers are visible (see box labelled **(a)** in the illustration below).

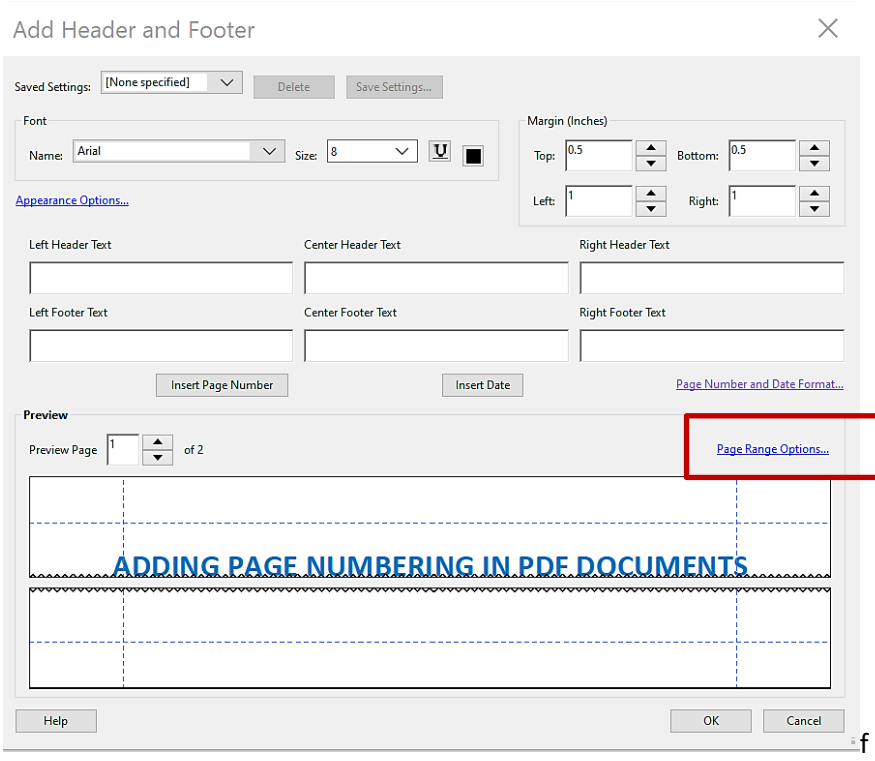
b) Click on **Page Number and Date Format** (see box labelled **(b)** in the illustration below) and set the **Page Number Format** (suggested format: **1**) and **Start Page Number** (the page number of the first page of your combined PDF (usually 1)).

c) To add page numbers to the top middle of your page, click inside the white rectangle directly beneath **Center Header Text** (see box labelled **(c)** in the illustration below) and then click the **Insert Page Number** button (see box labelled **(d)** in the illustration below).

d) The position of the page numbers can be adjusted by changing the position of the **Margin** within the 'Add Header and Footer' dialog box (see box labelled **(e)** in the illustration below). Refer to the preview box in the bottom half of the dialogue box to see a preview of how the page numbers will appear on the pages of the combined PDF document.



3. If you do not want to page number every page in the document click on **Page Range Options…**. Specify which page range you wish to page number, then select **OK.**



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Note: *You may choose to start page numbering* ***after*** *the Index/Table of Contents or* ***on*** *the cover page (i.e., on page 1).*

4. Select **OK** to apply the page numbering to your combined PDF document.

5. Note: If page number one (1) starts after the Index/Table of Contents, you **must** update page numbers with page labels to ensure when searching for specific page numbers you will go to the correct page number. For further instructions, refer to Updating Page Numbers with Page Labels for Searching in Acrobat.

Note: You can update the sequential page numbering by choosing **Edit PDF** in the **Tools** toolbar (or in the Edit menu bar), then clicking on the **Header & Footer** toolbar, and choosing **Update …**